

Welcome to Cover Whale, Christian Castillo!



Welcome to Your First Week at Cover Whale!

Welcome to the team! We're thrilled that you've joined a company where energy, collaboration, and purpose drive everything we do. From day one, you'll feel the momentum of a team that moves fast, supports one another, and celebrates the enthusiasm that fuels our success.

Your onboarding journey is designed not only to help you understand your role and our business but to connect you with the people and culture that make Cover Whale an extraordinary place to grow your career. The first week sets the tone for your success — one built on curiosity, teamwork, and a shared commitment to making an impact together.

Our onboarding program follows six key stages, each designed to help you learn, connect, and contribute while reinforcing our culture of drive and collaboration. You'll be encouraged to build relationships, share ideas, and embrace a high-energy environment where feedback and growth are part of everyday work.

Start Date — Monday, May 11, 2026

The Six Stages of Onboarding

1. Preboarding – IT Onboarding

Before your first day, our IT and HR teams ensure your tools and systems are ready for you to hit the ground running.

2. Day One – Orientation

Day One is all about connection and excitement. You'll meet your team, learn our mission and values, and see how your work contributes to our bigger vision. We'll introduce you to the high-energy, collaborative culture that sets us apart.

3. Week One – Inclusion Survey

During your first week, you'll share feedback through a short inclusion survey. Your perspective helps us continue building an environment where every team member feels respected, welcomed, and part of something bigger. Inclusion fuels collaboration, and collaboration drives innovation.

4. 30-Day – Learning Check-In and Survey

After your first month, you'll meet with your manager to reflect on what you've learned. This check-in is an opportunity to celebrate progress, ask questions, and explore how to grow your confidence and knowledge in a fast-paced, supportive setting.

5. 60-Day – Contributing Check-In and Survey

By this point, you'll be actively contributing to projects and making your mark. Your check-in focuses on alignment — ensuring you have the tools, clarity, and encouragement you need to keep performing at your best while staying connected to our team's collaborative rhythm.

6. 90-Day – Challenging & Safety Check-In and Survey

At the 90-day mark, you'll reflect on how far you've come and look ahead to new challenges. This stage emphasizes psychological safety — creating a space where you can speak up, challenge ideas respectfully, and take smart risks. We believe that innovation thrives when people feel safe to bring their whole selves to work and stretch beyond their comfort zones.

Onboarding Day One: Program Schedule

Date: Monday, May 11, 2026

Objectives - Day One - Introduction				
▪ Learn about Cover Whale and our Culture ▪ Gain access to our systems and tools ▪ Meet the Team				
		What functional area?	Who are the key people to meet with?	What should they learn or take away from their time with them?
8:30 AM – 9:15 AM	IT Onboarding with Jose Selemi	Onboarding & Setup	Jose Selemi	System access, software, credentials. Google Meet.
9:30 AM – 10:15 AM	HR Onboarding with Maria L	Onboarding & Setup	Maria Latushko	Benefits, PTO, The Harbor, Slack, I-9 verification.
10:20 AM – 10:50 AM	CW Culture with April Squillante	Onboarding & Setup	April Squillante	Mission, vision, core values, history.
11:00 AM – 11:45 AM	Onboarding Roadmap w/George Soteropoulos	Onboarding & Setup	George Soteropoulos	Growth Team overview, onboarding roadmap, org chart.
12:00 PM – 1:00 PM	Lunch	Break	—	
1:00 PM – 1:30 PM	KnowBe4 Cyber Security Training	Onboarding & Setup	Self	Mandatory cyber security awareness training (training.knowbe4.com).
1:30 PM – 2:00 PM	Self Study: Harassment Code of Conduct Training	Self-Study	Self	Required compliance training — HiBob / ADP.
2:00 PM – 3:30 PM	Monthly Cover Whale Town Hall	Company-wide	Leadership	Company strategic initiatives, updates, Q&A. FTE-wide.
3:30 PM – 4:00 PM	Manager Welcome	Leadership	Cory Arnette	Role expectations, scorecard, 90-day goals.

Onboarding Day Two: Program Schedule

Date: Tuesday, May 12, 2026

Objectives - Day Two - Inclusion

- Understand Cover Whale's mission, market, and Ideal Customer Profile
- Learn our agent personas and how we segment the trucking market
- Meet key Growth leaders (Cory Arnette, Kevin McKernan, James Reid)

Time	Agenda Topic	Team	Leader	Desired Outcomes
9:00 AM – 9:45 AM	Intro to Growth Team w/George Soteropoulos	Onboarding & Setup	George Soteropoulos	Team structure, roles, goals, how the team operates.
10:30 AM – 11:00 AM	Meet James Reid: Networks Distribution Leader	Growth Team	James Reid	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
11:00 AM – 12:00 PM	Self Study: ARC – Getting Started	Self-Study	Self	Walk through ARC: dashboard, navigation, key tools.
12:00 PM – 1:00 PM	Lunch	Break	—	
1:00 PM – 1:45 PM	Who is Cover Whale? w/George Soteropoulos	Onboarding & Setup	George Soteropoulos	Company deep-dive — history, mission, market position.
2:00 PM – 2:30 PM	Meet Cory Arnette: Director, Growth & Distribution Strategy	Growth Team	Cory Arnette	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
2:30 PM – 3:15 PM	ICP / Agent Personas w/George Soteropoulos	Product & Industry	George Soteropoulos	Ideal Customer Profile and Agent Persona deck.
3:30 PM – 4:00 PM	Meet Kevin McKernan: VP, Fleet Sales	Growth Team	Kevin McKernan	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
4:00 PM – 4:30 PM	Self Study: Trucking Industry Statistics & Trends	Self-Study	Self	Foundational trucking industry context — market size, regulations, trends.

Onboarding Day Three: Program Schedule

Date: Wednesday, May 13, 2026

Objectives - Day Three - Learning

- Master Cover Whale's coverage options, appetite, and pricing
- Build and rehearse your Cover Whale elevator pitch
- Read SAFER, SNAP, and BASIC reports to qualify trucking risks

Time	Agenda Topic	Team	Leader	Desired Outcomes
8:30 AM – 9:00 AM	Networks Stand-up (Maxwell only)	Recurring	James Reid	Daily Networks vertical stand-up — Maxwell starts attending.
9:00 AM – 9:45 AM	Coverage Deep Dive w/George Soteropoulos	Product & Industry	George Soteropoulos	Coverage mastery — types, appetite, pricing, state availability.
9:45 AM – 10:15 AM	Meet Ian Abrahamsen: CRM & Marketing Operations Specialist	Growth Team	Ian Abrahamsen	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
10:30 AM – 11:00 AM	Meet Pat Flood: Growth Marketing & Partnerships Strategy Manager	Growth Team	Pat Flood	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
11:30 AM – 12:15 PM	UW <=> Growth Collab	Cross-Functional	Mandy / Amber / Sabina (UW) + Growth Team	Underwriting & Growth biweekly cross-functional sync.
12:15 PM – 1:15 PM	Lunch	Break	—	
2:00 PM – 2:45 PM	SAFER SNAP/BASIC w/Roland Massey	Product & Industry	Roland Massey	SAFER system — SNAP and BASIC report interpretation.
2:45 PM – 3:30 PM	Self Study: ARC – Our Guidelines	Self-Study	Self	Read through Cover Whale guidelines section in ARC.

Onboarding Day Four: Program Schedule

Date: Thursday, May 14, 2026

Objectives - Day Four - Contributing

- Learn the Fleet product offering and underwriting approach
- Connect with the BDA / BDM team across East, Central, and Western regions
- Understand cross-functional partners — Billing, Renewals, and PBRM

Time	Agenda Topic	Team	Leader	Desired Outcomes
8:30 AM – 9:15 AM	Elevator Pitch Intro w/George Soteropoulos	Sales Development	George Soteropoulos	Craft your Cover Whale pitch — 60-second version.
9:30 AM – 10:00 AM	Meet Cassandra Kenna: Senior Product Manager, Experience & Finance	Growth Team	Cassandra Kenna	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
10:00 AM – 11:00 AM	Self Study: ARC – Coverage Options	Self-Study	Self	Deep dive into ARC coverage options and appetite.
11:00 AM – 12:00 PM	Growth Weekly Synch	Recurring	Cory Arnette + Growth Team	Weekly growth team alignment.
12:00 PM – 12:30 PM	Meet Christopher Hayes: Senior Business Development Manager	Growth Team	Christopher Hayes	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
12:30 PM – 1:00 PM	Lunch	Break	—	
1:00 PM – 2:00 PM	AI Demo Days	Company-wide	Daniel Medina + Speakers	FTE-wide AI tool showcase.
2:00 PM – 2:30 PM	Meet Antonio Reyes: BDM, Networks / Aggregators	Growth Team	Antonio Reyes	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
2:30 PM – 3:00 PM	AI Acceptable Use Policy Training	Company-wide	Daniel Medina	FTE-wide AI policy training.
3:00 PM – 3:45 PM	Fleet Product Offering w/Kevin McKernan	Product & Industry	Kevin McKernan	Fleet product — appetite, underwriting, growth strategy.
3:45 PM – 4:30 PM	Sequences w/Cameron Brader	Sales Development	Cameron Brader	Outreach sequences — structure, cadence, templates.

Onboarding Day Five: Program Schedule

Date: Friday, May 15, 2026

Objectives - Day Five - Action & Territory

- Meet executive leadership (Nyles Oppenheimer, CRO) and align on growth vision
- Plan your territory strategy and weekly outreach cadence
- Deliver your elevator pitch and complete required compliance training

Time	Agenda Topic	Team	Leader	Desired Outcomes
8:30 AM – 9:00 AM	Networks Stand-up (Maxwell only)	Recurring	James Reid	Daily Networks vertical stand-up.
11:00 AM – 11:45 AM	Smart Quote Demo w/ Dan	Growth-team-wide	Dan + Nyles	Smart Quote tool demo for Growth Team.
11:45 AM – 12:15 PM	Meet Nyles Oppenheimer: Chief Revenue Officer (individual 1:1)	Leadership	Nyles Oppenheimer	CRO perspective, expectations, growth vision (individual 1:1).
12:15 PM – 12:45 PM	Self Study / Buffer	Self-Study	Self	Buffer during the other new hire's Nyles 1:1.
12:45 PM – 1:45 PM	Lunch	Break	—	
2:30 PM – 3:15 PM	Territory Introduction w/Roland Massey	Territory	Roland Massey	Territory mapping and account overview.
3:15 PM – 3:45 PM	Meet Derrick Leroy: BDM, Central Region	Growth Team	Derrick Leroy	Team introduction — role overview, current focus, how to engage.
3:45 PM – 4:15 PM	Cover Whale Pitch — Manager Voicemail	Assessment	Cory Arnette	Leave Cover Whale pitch on manager voicemail (1:1).
4:15 PM – 4:45 PM	Weekly Recap & Debrief w/George	Debrief	George Soteropoulos	Week 1 summary and Week 2 preview.

Tools & Systems:

- ✓ Employee Portals: HiBob and ADP (payroll and benefits)
- ✓ Benefits and Compensation: The Harbor, ADP Total Source, Anthem, Voya (401k)
- ✓ Communication: Slack [Slack Certified](#), Gmail
- ✓ Finance: Sage, ePay
- ✓ Learning: ADP, KnowBe4, HiBob, Knowledge Resources Center
- ✓ Productivity: G Suite, Microsoft 365
- ✓ Reporting: Metabase; [Getting Started with Metabase](#)
- ✓ Systems: Trucking Portal, Talk Desk, HubSpot
- ✓ Tech Tools: Jira, HubSpot [Hubspot Onboarding Dashboard](#)

Other Resources

- [Organimi](#) (Org chart)